



“I DO NOT CONSIDER MYSELF TO BE AN ‘ILLUSTRIOUS PERSONALITY’ BUT ONLY AN ORDINARY BUSINESSMAN AND CITIZEN WHO HAS TRIED TO MAKE THE BEST OF HIS OPPORTUNITIES TO ADVANCE THE CAUSE OF INDIA’S INDUSTRIAL AND ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT.”

Scion of a noble house

JRD Tata was the son of RD Tata (a cousin of the visionary Jamsetji Tata, and a partner in the business) and his French wife, Suzanne. Young Jehangir’s childhood was spent in India, France and Japan. He spoke fluent French and held both British-Indian and French citizenship until he gave the latter up. As a young man, his plan to study engineering at Cambridge was derailed by the outbreak of World War I. He undertook a stint in the French army, but did not resume his studies at the end of the war. Instead, he joined